

Architecture — Marks vs working window

Same motion board, two operator models. **JKSlider** stores **A/B/C marks** (waypoints). **B4Slider** uses an **A/B window (working window)** — a travel clip that is the shot.

B4 user manuals keep the word A/B on purpose. Most motorized-slider operators look for “A/B”, not “window”. Headings such as *Soft limits (A / B window)* exist so they find the similar feature. The two A/B’s are **not the same job**.

How-to: [JKSlider — A / B / C](#) · [B4Slider — A / B window](#). Faces: [marketing.md](#).

Layers

Both faces talk millimetres to SliderMC. Hardware and the planner always clip travel. The UIC then chooses **marks** or a **working window**.

LAYER	WHAT IT IS	WHO
Hard limit	Switch (SW_HOME / SW_LIMIT_*); red LED	Both apps
MC soft limit	slider_min / slider_max — planner will not command past	Always on the MC. Full rail unless the UIC shrinks it
Mark	PosA / PosB / PosC — goto target, not a wall	JKSlider
Working window (manuals: A/B)	soft_limit_L / soft_limit_R — a wall and the MOVE target	B4Slider

B4Slider implements the working window by **writing the UIC shot into those same MC soft limits**. JKSlider leaves MC limits at full rail (or installer setup) and stores marks in the app.

MOVE / FAST / joystick on JKSlider can still travel the full MC clip. Goto and loops **aim at** a mark. On B4Slider, MOVE_L/R cruise **to** the window ends; the carriage **cannot** leave until you reset a side (or both).

Marks (JKSlider A/B/C)

Search term and mechanism match: A/B/C are waypoints, the language most motorized-slider operators already know.

What it does. A mark is a **bookmark** on the rail. You store the carriage pose as A, B, or C. Later you tap that key and the slider **goes there**. The rest of the rail stays usable: MOVE / FAST / joystick are not trapped between A and B.

Short workflow

- Jog to the start of the shot. Hold **A** to save PosA.
- Jog to the end. Hold **B** to save PosB.
- Tap **A** to return to start; tap **B** to play the move.
- Optional: hold **C** for a third pose — tap B, wait, tap C for the second beat.
- You can still MOVE or FAST **past** A/B if you need to reframe (that is the point of a mark, not a wall).

Pros

Even with A, B, or C set, the slider can still move **outside** the marks (reframe, home, FAST to the rail end).
Natural **flow**: A→B, wait, B→C (third beat). Loops AB / AC / BC.
OLED ETAs between marks; positions remembered after power-off.

Cons

Needs **A/B/C keys** (or a keypad) — larger panel.
MOVE can **leave the framed shot** unless the operator uses goto.
Three marks and chords (A+B, OPTION+A, ...) are more to learn.
Loops are explicit pairs, not “whatever the current window is.”

Working window (B4Slider A/B)

Here **A/B** is the **label** for the working window, not a bookmark. Keys stay SET + MOVE_L/R. API names stay soft_limit_L / soft_limit_R.
Architecture does not call this a “limit window” — “limit” reads as a safety end-stop (hard switch / full-rail clip), which is the layer **above**.

What it does. The working window is the **allowed stretch/shrink of rail**. You set a left end and a right end. Those ends are both a **wall** (you cannot leave) and the **MOVE target** (MOVE_L cruises to the left end and stops). There is no separate “go to A” key — left and right **are** A/B in the manual.

Short workflow

- Jog to the first pose. **SET + MOVE_L** tap — that is now the left end (A).
- Jog to the second pose. **SET + MOVE_R** tap — that is now the right end (B).
- Tap **MOVE_L** or **MOVE_R** — the carriage cruises to that end and **stops**. You cannot roll past it.
- To reframe outside, hold **SET + MOVE** on that side to open it back to full rail (or reset both).

Pros

- Fewer buttons** — SET + MOVE_L/R instead of A/B/C.
- Easier handling**: MOVE_L/R **is** the A/B move (cruise to the soft end).
- Stop-at-end behaviour **already exists** at the mechanical / MC limit; the shot just **shrinks** that same stop.

Cons

- You **cannot sneak past** the framed ends to reframe without resetting the window (or opening one side).
- No C** — no A→B wait B→C story beat on this panel.
- The similar-looking “A/B” **clips travel**; it is not a bookmark you can leave and return to while jogging the rest of the rail.
- Accidental SET + MOVE tap **shrinks the whole rail** until hold-reset (white blip).
- B4 **does not remember** the window after power-off (full travel again). JKSlider **does** remember PosA/B/C.

When to pick which

Not a third product — pick the UIC that matches the shoot and the plate.

PICK	WHEN
JKSlider / marks	Narrative moves, timelapse with three poses, need to jog past the shot, OLED ETAs between marks, operators who want Kessler-style A/B as waypoints
B4Slider / working window	4-button plate, no OLED, “left and right are the A/B window,” ping-pong loops between ends, slim or budget remote

Do not put both models on one panel without a mode switch. Mixing “A is a mark” and “L is a wall” on the same keys is how operators overshoot or trap the carriage.

A later hybrid is possible (for example a B4 chord to restore full MC travel without forgetting L/R, or JKSlider MOVE clipped to A→B while FAST still leaves the window). Shipping apps stay **one model each**.

